LAND & LEDGERS

HISTORICAL TIMELINE, EVENTS AND ECONOMIC REGIMES

RESEARCH REFERENCE — FIRST EDITION (CURRENT REFERENCE)

Date: 8 October 2026 | **Period:** 1870–1905 | **Authority:** Reference and authoring evidence only; Canon XXXI governs mechanics.

This catalog is deliberately a **dated, cited research record**, not a list of automatic economic modifiers. A nationwide crisis may create financial/counterparty strain while a rural Dakota node without relevant lender connections sees a delayed or small effect. Conversely, an independently generated drought or lender failure is still allowed when named historical event injection is disabled.

I. Four noninterchangeable classes of historical entry

Authored historical event (EVT) — A researched named crisis, outbreak, or incident that may inject scoped causal inputs only when enabled by the scenario Historical Events setting.

Historical period or regime (REG) — A longer state of institutions, outside trade networks or development conditions; effects still require real local exposure, information and counterparties.

Legal or availability boundary (LAW/CTX) — A fixed date when legal jurisdiction, organizational powers or channel availability changes; these are not discretionary crisis cards and are not disabled merely by toggling Historical Events OFF.

Campaign baseline (HIST) — World setup envelope and authoring priors; dated evidence should constrain generation but must not force historical outcomes when player/NPC action changes the conditions.

II. Event-evaluation grammar

EventDefinition (stable ID) -> date window and applicable region -> research/evidence check -> scenario authored toggle if applicable -> affected authoritative inputs (weather/route, finance/lender, crop/animal, information, person/household, law) -> ordinary tasks, agreement performance, prices and choices -> player-facing evidence and forecast.

Never inject: arbitrary Revenue=-20%, Population+50, immediate livestock disappearance, a depot because the calendar reached 1886, automatic bankruptcy upon panic, or an invisible forced settlement script.

Event record minimum fields: ID; title; valid period and geographic scope; class/toggle eligibility; historical source and research grade; local exposure conditions; causal input authorities; known uncertainty; save version; applied-event identity; reversible or irreversible actions; narrative/reporting access; scenario-specific overrides.

III. Verified and provisional catalog

ID

Event / regime

Time

Classification

Research status

HIST-1870-BASE

Early 1870 frontier baseline

1870-01-01

Baseline / historical context

DESIGN BASELINE

EVT-1872-EQUINE

Great equine influenza epizootic

1872

Authored historical regional disease event

PROVISIONAL — RESEARCH GEOGRAPHY

EVT-1873-PANIC

Panic of 1873 and following contraction

1873-09

Authored historical financial regime

VERIFIED CORE, CALIBRATION OPEN

EVT-1874-GRASSHOPPER

Northern plains grasshopper outbreaks

1874

Authored environmental regime candidate

RESEARCH HOLD

REG-1878-1880-GROWTH

Dakota settlement and land-entry expansion

1878

Long regional historical regime / migration context

REGIONAL SYNTHESIS — NEED ROUTE DATA

EVT-1884-PANIC

Panic of 1884

1884-05

Authored financial event candidate with limited spread

VERIFIED NATIONAL SCOPE; LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL

EVT-1886-WINTER

Severe northern plains winter of 1886–87

1886-11

Authored regional environmental disaster

VERIFIED REGIONAL, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN

EVT-1888-BLIZZARD

Children’s Blizzard, 12 January 1888

1888-01-12

Authored dated weather/route disturbance

VERIFIED DATE AND SOME REGIONAL EFFECTS

LAW-1889-STATE

Dakota statehood / jurisdiction transition

1889-11-02

Historical legal boundary

VERIFIED HISTORICAL DATE

EVT-1890-PANIC

Financial strain and Panic of 1890

1890

Authored national financial event candidate

VERIFIED EVENT, LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL

EVT-1893-PANIC

Panic of 1893 and depression

1893

Authored financial regime

VERIFIED MACRO, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN

CTX-1896-RFD

Rural Free Delivery experimentation begins

1896-10-01

Technology/service availability chronology

VERIFIED ONSET

LAW-1898-BANKRUPTCY

Federal Bankruptcy Act of 1898

1898-07-01

Historical federal legal boundary

VERIFIED LEGAL EVENT

LAW-1902-RECLAMATION

Reclamation Act of 1902

1902-06-17

Historical federal institutional/legal boundary

VERIFIED ENACTMENT, PROJECT MAPPING OPEN

CTX-1905-END

Normal historical envelope ends

1905-12-31

Campaign authoring boundary

DESIGN BOUNDARY

IV. Individual historical research entries

HIST-1870-BASE — Early 1870 frontier baseline

Period: 1870-01-01 to 1872-12-31. **Class:** Baseline / historical context. **Geography:** Dakota and nearby plains.

Evidence: Source synthesis; DESIGN BASELINE.

Causal/world pathways: Sparse local rail/telegraph support, established animal/river transport, rural social and commercial networks.

Caution / eligibility: Opening scenario may begin in spring 1870; do not turn off geography with event toggle.

Sources: Canon XXXI PDF pp.72–82 (preserved Canon XXV).

EVT-1872-EQUINE — Great equine influenza epizootic

Period: 1872 to 1873. **Class:** Authored historical regional disease event. **Geography:** North America; per-district exposure must be sourced.

Evidence: Library of Congress archival; PROVISIONAL — RESEARCH GEOGRAPHY.

Causal/world pathways: Affected horse availability/condition -> wagon, stage, delivery, freight and ordinary travel capacity -> service delays and economic consequences.

Caution / eligibility: Do not assume every Dakota team infected simultaneously or apply universal revenue loss.

Sources: https://blogs.loc.gov/manuscripts/2026/05/when-the-horse-flu-came-for-alexander-graham-bells-boston/.

EVT-1873-PANIC — Panic of 1873 and following contraction

Period: 1873-09 to 1879 (broad aftermath; exact use scoped). **Class:** Authored historical financial regime. **Geography:** United States; local lender exposure conditional.

Evidence: Federal Reserve / US Treasury; VERIFIED CORE, CALIBRATION OPEN.

Causal/world pathways: Rail bond markets and institutions -> financing availability, withdrawals, lender risk, project cancellations -> employment, migration and purchases.

Caution / eligibility: No direct price/profit percentage debuff; credit network and geography determine impact.

Sources: https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age ; https://home.treasury.gov/about/history/freedmans-bank-building/financial-panic-of-1873.

EVT-1874-GRASSHOPPER — Northern plains grasshopper outbreaks

Period: 1874 to 1877. **Class:** Authored environmental regime candidate. **Geography:** Regional agriculture; site/year intensity to be established.

Evidence: Canon source only pending direct dated corroboration; RESEARCH HOLD.

Causal/world pathways: Actual crop loss and planting decisions -> household food and feed, credit, migration, merchant supply.

Caution / eligibility: Not eligible for exact dated scripted effects until Dakota evidence is verified.

Sources: Canon XXXI preserved historical regime material (pages 25–35); additional period records required.

REG-1878-1880-GROWTH — Dakota settlement and land-entry expansion

Period: 1878 to 1887. **Class:** Long regional historical regime / migration context. **Geography:** Dakota Territory, corridors differ.

Evidence: Canon synthesis with chronology hold; REGIONAL SYNTHESIS — NEED ROUTE DATA.

Causal/world pathways: Awareness, claims, rail approaches, land sales/settlement contacts, credit -> actor decisions and construction.

Caution / eligibility: The historical label Great Dakota Boom must not force the same town growth in every seed.

Sources: Canon XXXI preserved XXV/XXIX.

EVT-1884-PANIC — Panic of 1884

Period: 1884-05 to 1884. **Class:** Authored financial event candidate with limited spread. **Geography:** Predominantly New York financial firms.

Evidence: Federal Reserve History; VERIFIED NATIONAL SCOPE; LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL.

Causal/world pathways: Bank/funding relationship exposure -> reputation, correspondent terms and firm borrowing where actual connections exist.

Caution / eligibility: Do not treat as nationwide depression.

Sources: https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age.

EVT-1886-WINTER — Severe northern plains winter of 1886–87

Period: 1886-11 to 1887-04. **Class:** Authored regional environmental disaster. **Geography:** Northern Plains cattle range; heterogeneous local severity.

Evidence: US National Park Service; VERIFIED REGIONAL, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN.

Causal/world pathways: Local snow/ice, forage scarcity, weakened livestock and limited water -> injury, starvation, losses, herd distress -> finance and market effects.

Caution / eligibility: Do not globally delete 80% of all Dakota cattle; losses varied widely by specific location and husbandry.

Sources: https://www.nps.gov/thro/learn/historyculture/theodore-roosevelt-the-rancher.htm ; https://www.nps.gov/grko/learn/historyculture/winter.htm.

EVT-1888-BLIZZARD — Children's Blizzard, 12 January 1888

Period: 1888-01-12 to 1888-01. **Class:** Authored dated weather/route disturbance. **Geography:** Eastern Dakota and upper Midwest hardest; Black Hills different.

Evidence: US National Weather Service; VERIFIED DATE AND SOME REGIONAL EFFECTS.

Causal/world pathways: Extreme cold, winds and drift -> impassable routes, telegraph disruption, rail stoppage, exposed Persons/animals, delays.

Caution / eligibility: Do not assume uniform fatalities, snowfall or service failure at every node.

Sources: https://www.weather.gov/unr/1888-01-12.

LAW-1889-STATE — Dakota statehood / jurisdiction transition

Period: 1889-11-02 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical legal boundary; NON-OPTIONAL except alternate history. **Geography:** North Dakota and South Dakota.

Evidence: US Senate state timeline; VERIFIED HISTORICAL DATE.

Causal/world pathways: Territorial to state legal-institution regime; existing contracts, institutions and geography require actual continuity rules.

Caution / eligibility: Must remain effective when Historical Events toggle is OFF.

Sources: https://www.senate.gov/states/SD/timeline.shtml ; https://www.senate.gov/states/ND/timeline.shtml.

EVT-1890-PANIC — Financial strain and Panic of 1890

Period: 1890 to 1890. **Class:** Authored national financial event candidate. **Geography:** Money centers; regional links uncertain.

Evidence: Federal Reserve History; VERIFIED EVENT, LOCAL EFFECT CONDITIONAL.

Causal/world pathways: Money-center liquidity/reputational strain may transmit along actual correspondent and credit ties.

Caution / eligibility: Not a universal Dakota banking shutdown.

Sources: https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age.

EVT-1893-PANIC — Panic of 1893 and depression

Period: 1893 to 1897 (broad later recovery). **Class:** Authored financial regime. **Geography:** US-wide banking, rail and regional exposure varies.

Evidence: Federal Reserve History; FDIC history; VERIFIED MACRO, LOCAL CALIBRATION OPEN.

Causal/world pathways: Depositor withdrawal, gold/monetary strain, railroad failure, lender liquidity, contracting commerce and credit -> local propagation.

Caution / eligibility: Never directly reduce each firm revenue; impose/derive only causal changes.

Sources: https://www.federalreservehistory.org/essays/banking-panics-of-the-gilded-age ; https://www.fdic.gov/history/1850-1899.

CTX-1896-RFD — Rural Free Delivery experimentation begins

Period: 1896-10-01 to adoption varies by place. **Class:** Technology/service availability chronology; NON-OPTIONAL factual boundary. **Geography:** Initial experiment West Virginia; later routes elsewhere.

Evidence: US Postal Service; VERIFIED ONSET.

Causal/world pathways: Actual post-office/route roll-out changes mail travel, shopping information and market reach, not immediate universal rural delivery.

Caution / eligibility: Do not grant every Dakota household home delivery in 1896.

Sources: https://about.usps.com/who/profile/history/rural-free-delivery.htm.

LAW-1898-BANKRUPTCY — Federal Bankruptcy Act of 1898

Period: 1898-07-01 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical federal legal boundary; NON-OPTIONAL except alternate history. **Geography:** United States with eligibility/court constraints.

Evidence: Federal Judicial Center / US Courts; VERIFIED LEGAL EVENT.

Causal/world pathways: Adds federal bankruptcy proceeding path separate from state law; no modern Chapter 7/11 mechanics.

Caution / eligibility: No automatic dissolution or universal personal bankruptcy reset.

Sources: https://www.rib.uscourts.gov/sites/default/files/FJC%20Bankruptcy%20Timeline.pdf ; https://www.mnb.uscourts.gov/history-us-bankruptcy-court-district-minnesota.

LAW-1902-RECLAMATION — Reclamation Act of 1902

Period: 1902-06-17 to ongoing. **Class:** Historical federal institutional/legal boundary. **Geography:** Affected western projects; local site inclusion not guaranteed.

Evidence: US Bureau of Reclamation; VERIFIED ENACTMENT, PROJECT MAPPING OPEN.

Causal/world pathways: Federal planning/finance capacity for authorized irrigation work; individual projects need budgets, land, labor, water and construction.

Caution / eligibility: Act does not auto-build every western irrigation system.

Sources: https://www.usbr.gov/history/borhist.html ; https://www.usbr.gov/gp/about_us/aboutus_history.html.

CTX-1905-END — Normal historical envelope ends

Period: 1905-12-31 to 1905-12-31. **Class:** Campaign authoring boundary. **Geography:** Default campaign.

Evidence: Canon XXXI; DESIGN BOUNDARY.

Causal/world pathways: End-of-envelope for period accuracy; scenario may end earlier or authored continuation separately.

Caution / eligibility: Avoid 1908 mail-order kit homes or post-1913 Federal Reserve systems in ordinary 1870-1905 scenarios.

Sources: Canon XXXI (current revision, p.1 and historical envelope appendix).

V. Research holds and exclusions

Grasshopper and local crop crises: An 1874–1877 episode is a promising historical regime candidate but requires direct Dakota time/place/source confirmation before implementing a fixed event ID with local crop multipliers.

Great Dakota Boom: Treat settlement, railway approach, migration and land acquisition as processes through real agents; do not force every player settlement to grow on a historical aggregate boom schedule.

Railroad arrival: Retain independent infrastructure and commercial service stages; Black Hills and Southeastern Dakota rail dates require corridor and corporate verification.

Indigenous treaty, reservation and land-law changes: Land jurisdiction and rights require their own REF-02 legal-geography catalog; they are not generic optional 'disaster' toggles.

Conflicting mortality/loss percentages: Ranch loss figures from different NPS cases apply to their described herds and ranges; never generalize a local 80% report to all ranches.

Post-horizon exclusions: Postal Parcel Post (1913), the Federal Reserve System (1913) and Sears kit houses beginning in 1908 must not enter normal-period availability catalogs by mistake.

VI. Acceptance fixtures

PANIC-1873 OFF: Authored national Panic inputs do not inject; an organic bank with real deposit-liquidity shortage can still fail.

PANIC-1873 ON, isolated town: Only connected lenders, railway finance and other real economic routes transmit relevant historical disturbance; unrelated local inventories are not automatically repriced.

BLIZZARD-1888 geographic contrast: Physical route and communication damage in a represented corridor may differ materially across Black Hills and eastern Dakota; do not stamp the same fatality, snow-depth or road-blocking profile everywhere.

STATEHOOD-1889 event toggle OFF: Dated state/legal geography remains in effect; existing debt/title/Persons persist without being rewritten.

RFD-1896: An isolated Dakota farm does not automatically receive a newly completed rural mail route simply because West Virginia began a federal experiment.

RECLAMATION-1902: Federal program exists, but unfinished local irrigation works do not produce water deliveries or create farm revenue until actual projects and water-service rights exist.

VII. Evidence standard

Official government histories and period engineering records support specific factual dates or mechanisms. Geographic extrapolation is labeled. A reference date does not prove exact profitability, incidence, labor days or annual event magnitude in a procedurally generated town. Scenario-specific numeric calibration requires separate evidence.

Next linked reference: Historical Law, Land Rights and Institutions (REF-02), followed by economy and workforce calibration refreshes.